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United States Patent	12387241
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 12, 2025
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Media preview system

Abstract

The media preview system receives media content from one or more client devices, generates a preview of the media content, associates a coded image with the preview within a database associated with the media preview system, detects scans of the coded image from client devices, and causes display of the preview at the client devices in response to detecting the scan.

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Appl. No.: 17/956592

Filed: September 29, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230017029 A1	Jan. 19, 2023

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 15711693 20170921 US 11568446 child-doc US 17956592

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06Q30/02 (20230101); G06F16/70 (20190101); G06Q30/0207 (20230101); G06Q30/0251 (20230101); H04L65/612 (20220101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G06Q30/0267** (20130101); **G06F16/70** (20190101); **G06Q30/0209** (20130101);
H04L65/612 (20220501);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G06Q (30/0267); G06Q (30/0209); G06F (16/70); H04L (65/612)

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/711,693, filed Sep. 21, 2017, which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Embodiments of the present disclosure relate generally to mobile computing technology and, more particularly, but not by way of limitation, to systems for generating and presenting previews of media content at a client device.

BACKGROUND

(2) Matrix barcodes, including for example QR codes, consist of squares arranged in grid patterns on white backgrounds, which can be read by an imaging device such as a camera, and processed

using techniques such as Reed-Solomon error correction until the image may be interpreted. Data may then be extracted from the patterns that are present in both horizontal and vertical components of the image.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) To easily identify the discussion of any particular element or act, the most significant digit or digits in a reference number refer to the figure number in which that element is first introduced.
- (2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram showing an example messaging system for exchanging data (e.g., messages and associated content) over a network in accordance with some embodiments, wherein the messaging system includes a media preview system.
- (3) FIG. 2 is block diagram illustrating further details regarding a messaging system, according to example embodiments.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram illustrating data which may be stored in the database of the messaging server system, according to certain example embodiments.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram illustrating a structure of a message, according to some embodiments, generated by a messaging client application for communication.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram illustrating an example access-limiting process, in terms of which access to content (e.g., an ephemeral message, and associated multimedia payload of data) or a content collection (e.g., an ephemeral message story) may be time-limited (e.g., made ephemeral) in accordance with some embodiments.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a block diagram illustrating various modules of a media preview system, according to certain example embodiments.
- (8) FIG. 7A includes a depiction of a coded image and a presentation of a preview of media content at a client device, according to certain example embodiments.
- (9) FIG. 7B includes a depiction of a preview library displayed at a client device, according to certain example embodiments.
- (10) FIG. 8 is a flowchart illustrating a method displaying a preview of media content at a client device, according to certain example embodiments.
- (11) FIG. 9 is a flowchart illustrating a method for denying access to a preview of media content at a client device, according to certain example embodiments.
- (12) FIG. 10 is a flowchart illustrating a method for denying access to a preview of media content at a client device, according to certain example embodiments.
- (13) FIG. 11 is a flowchart illustrating a method for displaying a preview of media content at a client device, according to certain example embodiments.
- (14) FIG. 12 is a flowchart illustrating a method for associating a new coded image with a preview of media content, according to certain example embodiments.
- (15) FIG. 13 is a block diagram illustrating a representative software architecture, which may be used in conjunction with various hardware architectures herein described and used to implement various embodiments.
- (16) FIG. 14 is a block diagram illustrating components of a machine, according to some example embodiments, able to read instructions from a machine-readable medium (e.g., a machine-readable storage medium) and perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (17) Embodiments of the present disclosure relate generally to mobile computing technology and, more particularly, but not by way of limitation, to systems for generating and presenting previews of media content at a client device.
- (18) It is uncommon for content creators to produce and release media content from a single draft-

rather, the content creators will generally revise the media content in an iterative process through feedback received from a group of reviewers. To do so, the content creators share drafts of media content with reviewers through various means that may for example include email, hosting drafts of the media content at a webpage, or other similar distribution methods.

(19) An issue with this process is that there is often no way of controlling who views the drafts of the media content, and further, that there is no simple way to control when and where a user may access and view the previews. For example, situations may arise wherein it may be favorable to keep drafts of media content confidential until time of release, due to changes which may be necessary. As a result, a system to enable controlled distribution of previews of media content, while allowing an administrative user the ability to alter or change the preview in real time, would prove to be an advantage.

(20) In accordance with some embodiments described herein, a media preview system may be or include any instrumentality or aggregate of instrumentalities operable to compute, process, store, display, generate, communicate, or apply various forms of data for generating coded images to facilitate the display of previews of media content at client devices. The media preview system receives media content from one or more client devices, generates a preview of the media content, associates a coded image with the preview within a database associated with the media preview system, detects scans of the coded image from client devices, and causes display of the preview at the client devices in response to detecting the scan. Coded images may for example include optical barcodes, such as QR codes. In some example embodiments, the coded images may include custom or non-standard functional patterns that may provide an aesthetically pleasing branded barcode that allows for an exclusive experience associated with the optical barcode. For example, an entity logo can be used as a finder pattern, and in some instances an alignment pattern, that is machine-readable using specialized software discussed herein. Further details pertaining to coded images can be For example, the media content may include media content associated with a marketing or advertising campaign to be distributed through a network to a population of users. The media preview system generates a preview of the media content, wherein the preview of the media content depicts a representation of the media content before the media content has been distributed to the population of users. For example, the media preview system may modify the media content by applying a watermark, or graphical border to the media content.

(21) In some example embodiments, the preview of the media content may include access parameters, wherein the access parameters define access conditions and restrictions to the preview of the media content. The access parameters may include predefined expiration events such as an expiration of an access timer or exceeding a request limit, or a combination of both. For example, in some embodiments, the media preview system may initiate an access timer in response to receiving an indication that a coded image has been scanned by a client device. The media preview system may thereby provide access to the preview of the media content in response to detecting scans of the coded image, until an expiration of the access timer. For example, the access timer may be configured to allow users to access the preview of the media content for a period of 24 hours from the first scan of the coded image. Upon determining that the access timer has expired, the media preview system may disassociate the preview with the coded image at the server, or may simply cause display of a graphical icon indicating that the coded image has expired.

(22) In further embodiments, the media preview system may assign a request limit to the coded image, such that the preview of the media content may only be accessed by scanning the coded image a predefined number of times (e.g., 50 scans). In such embodiments, the media preview system may increment a counter in response to detecting a scan of the coded image. Upon determining that a count of the scans of the coded image exceeds a threshold defined by a request limit, the media preview system may deny access to the preview. For example, the media preview system may disassociate the coded image from the preview at the server, or simply cause display of a notification at the client device, wherein the notification includes an indication that the request

limit has been exceeded.

(23) In some example embodiments, upon detecting an expiration event, the media preview system may disassociate the preview of the media content from the coded image at the server, generate a new coded image, associate the new coded image with the preview of the media content at the server, and notify an administrator associated with the media content of the new coded image, so that the administrator may distribute the new coded image.

(24) A media preview system may also, in some embodiments, associate multiple preview of media content with a single coded image. Upon detecting a scan of the coded image, the media preview system may generate and cause display of a preview library at the requesting device, wherein the preview library includes a presentation of each preview. A user of the requesting device may thereby select a preview from among the presentation within the preview library, and in response, the media preview system may cause display of the preview at the requesting device.

(25) The media preview system may, in one implementation, receive media content as submissions from one or more client devices, wherein the media content includes drafts of advertising media. Upon receiving the media content, the media preview system generates a preview of the media content, wherein the preview includes a presentation of the media content and a set of access parameters, wherein the access parameters define a duration of time, as well as a population of users, which may view the preview of the media content. The media preview system may additionally alter the media content by including a watermark, or other graphical element. Having generated the preview of the media content, the media preview system assigns a coded image, like a QR code, to the preview within a database, such that reference to the coded image causes the media preview system to retrieve the preview. The media preview system may share the coded image with a user, wherein the user may distribute or share the coded image as they please. For example, the user may forward the coded image to one or more reviewing users, who may access the preview by scanning the coded image with an enabled device. The user may then make changes or adjustments to the media content and the preview of the media content at the server side, and as reviewers scan to access the preview, the most recent preview of the media content may be presented.

(26) FIG. 1 is a block diagram showing an example messaging system **100** for exchanging data (e.g., messages and associated content) over a network. The messaging system **100** includes multiple client devices **102**, each of which hosts a number of applications including a messaging client application **104**. Each messaging client application **104** is communicatively coupled to other instances of the messaging client application **104** and a messaging server system **108** via a network **106** (e.g., the Internet).

(27) Accordingly, each messaging client application **104** is able to communicate and exchange data with another messaging client application **104** and with the messaging server system **108** via the network **106**. The data exchanged between messaging client applications **104**, and between a messaging client application **104** and the messaging server system **108**, includes functions (e.g., commands to invoke functions) as well as payload data (e.g., text, audio, video or other multimedia data).

(28) The messaging server system **108** provides server-side functionality via the network **106** to a particular messaging client application **104**. While certain functions of the messaging system **100** are described herein as being performed by either a messaging client application **104** or by the messaging server system **108**, it will be appreciated that the location of certain functionality either within the messaging client application **104** or the messaging server system **108** is a design choice. For example, it may be technically preferable to initially deploy certain technology and functionality within the messaging server system **108**, but to later migrate this technology and functionality to the messaging client application **104** where a client device **102** has a sufficient processing capacity.

(29) The messaging server system **108** supports various services and operations that are provided to

the messaging client application **104**. Such operations include transmitting data to, receiving data from, and processing data generated by the messaging client application **104**. In some embodiments, this data includes, message content, client device information, geolocation information, media annotation and overlays, message content persistence conditions, social network information, and live event information, as examples. In other embodiments, other data is used. Data exchanges within the messaging system **100** are invoked and controlled through functions available via user interfaces (UIs) of the messaging client application **104**.

(30) Turning now specifically to the messaging server system **108**, an Application Program Interface (API) server **110** is coupled to, and provides a programmatic interface to, an application server **112**. The application server **112** is communicatively coupled to a database server **118**, which facilitates access to a database **120** in which is stored data associated with messages processed by the application server **112**.

(31) Dealing specifically with the Application Program Interface (API) server **110**, this server receives and transmits message data (e.g., commands and message payloads) between the client device **102** and the application server **112**. Specifically, the Application Program Interface (API) server **110** provides a set of interfaces (e.g., routines and protocols) that can be called or queried by the messaging client application **104** in order to invoke functionality of the application server **112**. The Application Program Interface (API) server **110** exposes various functions supported by the application server **112**, including account registration, login functionality, the sending of messages, via the application server **112**, from a particular messaging client application **104** to another messaging client application **104**, the sending of media files (e.g., images or video) from a messaging client application **104** to the messaging server application **114**, and for possible access by another messaging client application **104**, the setting of a collection of media data (e.g., story), the retrieval of a list of friends of a user of a client device **102**, the retrieval of such collections, the retrieval of messages and content, the adding and deletion of friends to a social graph, the location of friends within a social graph, opening and application event (e.g., relating to the messaging client application **104**).

(32) The application server **112** hosts a number of applications and subsystems, including a messaging server application **114**, an image processing system **116**, a social network system **122**, and a media preview system **124**. The messaging server application **114** implements a number of message processing technologies and functions, particularly related to the aggregation and other processing of content (e.g., textual and multimedia content) included in messages received from multiple instances of the messaging client application **104**. As will be described in further detail, the text and media content from multiple sources may be aggregated into collections of content (e.g., called stories or galleries). These collections are then made available, by the messaging server application **114**, to the messaging client application **104**. Other processor and memory intensive processing of data may also be performed server-side by the messaging server application **114**, in view of the hardware requirements for such processing.

(33) The application server **112** also includes an image processing system **116** that is dedicated to performing various image processing operations, typically with respect to images or video received within the payload of a message at the messaging server application **114**.

(34) The social network system **122** supports various social networking functions services, and makes these functions and services available to the messaging server application **114**. To this end, the social network system **122** maintains and accesses an entity graph **304** within the database **120**. Examples of functions and services supported by the social network system **122** include the identification of other users of the messaging system **100** with which a particular user has relationships or is “following,” and also the identification of other entities and interests of a particular user.

(35) The application server **112** is communicatively coupled to a database server **118**, which facilitates access to a database **120** in which is stored data associated with messages processed by

the messaging server application **114**.

(36) FIG. 2 is block diagram illustrating further details regarding the messaging system **100**, according to example embodiments. Specifically, the messaging system **100** is shown to comprise the messaging client application **104** and the application server **112**, which in turn embody a number of some subsystems, namely an ephemeral timer system **202**, a collection management system **204** and an annotation system **206**.

(37) The ephemeral timer system **202** is responsible for enforcing the temporary access to content permitted by the messaging client application **104** and the messaging server application **114**. To this end, the ephemeral timer system **202** incorporates a number of timers that, based on duration and display parameters associated with a message, collection of messages (e.g., a SNAPCHAT story), or graphical element, selectively display and enable access to messages and associated content via the messaging client application **104**. Further details regarding the operation of the ephemeral timer system **202** are provided below.

(38) The collection management system **204** is responsible for managing collections of media (e.g., collections of text, image video and audio data). In some examples, a collection of content (e.g., messages, including images, video, text and audio) may be organized into an “event gallery” or an “event story.” Such a collection may be made available for a specified time period, such as the duration of an event to which the content relates. For example, content relating to a music concert may be made available as a “story” for the duration of that music concert. The collection management system **204** may also be responsible for publishing an icon that provides notification of the existence of a particular collection to the user interface of the messaging client application **104**.

(39) The collection management system **204** furthermore includes a curation interface **208** that allows a collection manager to manage and curate a particular collection of content. For example, the curation interface **208** enables an event organizer to curate a collection of content relating to a specific event (e.g., delete inappropriate content or redundant messages). Additionally, the collection management system **204** employs machine vision (or image recognition technology) and content rules to automatically curate a content collection. In certain embodiments, compensation may be paid to a user for inclusion of user generated content into a collection. In such cases, the curation interface **208** operates to automatically make payments to such users for the use of their content.

(40) The annotation system **206** provides various functions that enable a user to annotate or otherwise modify or edit media content associated with a message. For example, the annotation system **206** provides functions related to the generation and publishing of media overlays for messages processed by the messaging system **100**. The annotation system **206** operatively supplies a media overlay (e.g., a SNAPCHAT filter) to the messaging client application **104** based on a geolocation of the client device **102**. In another example, the annotation system **206** operatively supplies a media overlay to the messaging client application **104** based on other information, such as, social network information of the user of the client device **102**. A media overlay may include audio and visual content and visual effects. Examples of audio and visual content include pictures, texts, logos, animations, and sound effects. An example of a visual effect includes color overlaying. The audio and visual content or the visual effects can be applied to a media content item (e.g., a photo) at the client device **102**. For example, the media overlay including text that can be overlaid on top of a photograph generated taken by the client device **102**. In another example, the media overlay includes an identification of a location overlay (e.g., Venice beach), a name of a live event, or a name of a merchant overlay (e.g., Beach Coffee House). In another example, the annotation system **206** uses the geolocation of the client device **102** to identify a media overlay that includes the name of a merchant at the geolocation of the client device **102**. The media overlay may include other indicia associated with the merchant. The media overlays may be stored in the database **120** and accessed through the database server **118**.

(41) In one example embodiment, the annotation system **206** provides a user-based publication platform that enables users to select a geolocation on a map, and upload content associated with the selected geolocation. The user may also specify circumstances under which a particular media overlay should be offered to other users. The annotation system **206** generates a media overlay that includes the uploaded content and associates the uploaded content with the selected geolocation.

(42) In another example embodiment, the annotation system **206** provides a merchant-based publication platform that enables merchants to select a particular media overlay associated with a geolocation via a bidding process. For example, the annotation system **206** associates the media overlay of a highest bidding merchant with a corresponding geolocation for a predefined amount of time

(43) FIG. **3** is a schematic diagram **300** illustrating data **300** which may be stored in the database **120** of the messaging server system **108**, according to certain example embodiments. While the content of the database **120** is shown to comprise a number of tables, it will be appreciated that the data could be stored in other types of data structures (e.g., as an object-oriented database).

(44) The database **120** includes message data stored within a message table **314**. The entity table **302** stores entity data, including an entity graph **304**. Entities for which records are maintained within the entity table **302** may include individuals, corporate entities, organizations, objects, places, events etc. Regardless of type, any entity regarding which the messaging server system **108** stores data may be a recognized entity. Each entity is provided with a unique identifier, as well as an entity type identifier (not shown).

(45) The entity graph **304** furthermore stores information regarding relationships and associations between entities. Such relationships may be social, professional (e.g., work at a common corporation or organization) interested-based or activity-based, merely for example.

(46) The database **120** also stores annotation data, in the example form of filters, in an annotation table **312**. Filters for which data is stored within the annotation table **312** are associated with and applied to videos (for which data is stored in a video table **310**) and/or images (for which data is stored in an image table **308**). Filters, in one example, are overlays that are displayed as overlaid on an image or video during presentation to a recipient user. Filters may be of various types, including a user-selected filters from a gallery of filters presented to a sending user by the messaging client application **104** when the sending user is composing a message. Other types of filters include geolocation filters (also known as geo-filters) which may be presented to a sending user based on geographic location. For example, geolocation filters specific to a neighborhood or special location may be presented within a user interface by the messaging client application **104**, based on geolocation information determined by a GPS unit of the client device **102**. Another type of filter is a data filter, which may be selectively presented to a sending user by the messaging client application **104**, based on other inputs or information gathered by the client device **102** during the message creation process. Example of data filters include current temperature at a specific location, a current speed at which a sending user is traveling, battery life for a client device **102** or the current time.

(47) Other annotation data that may be stored within the image table **308** is so-called “lens” data. A “lens” may be a real-time special effect and sound that may be added to an image or a video.

(48) As mentioned above, the video table **310** stores video data which, in one embodiment, is associated with messages for which records are maintained within the message table **314**. Similarly, the image table **308** stores image data associated with messages for which message data is stored in the entity table **302**. The entity table **302** may associate various annotations from the annotation table **312** with various images and videos stored in the image table **308** and the video table **310**.

(49) A story table **306** stores data regarding collections of messages and associated image, video or audio data, which are compiled into a collection (e.g., a SNAPCHAT story or a gallery). The creation of a particular collection may be initiated by a particular user (e.g., each user for which a record is maintained in the entity table **302**) A user may create a “personal story” in the form of a

collection of content that has been created and sent/broadcast by that user. To this end, the user interface of the messaging client application **104** may include an icon that is user selectable to enable a sending user to add specific content to his or her personal story.

(50) A collection may also constitute a “live story,” which is a collection of content from multiple users that is created manually, automatically or using a combination of manual and automatic techniques. For example, a “live story” may constitute a curated stream of user-submitted content from various locations and events. Users, whose client devices have location services enabled and are at a common location event at a particular time may, for example, be presented with an option, via a user interface of the messaging client application **104**, to contribute content to a particular live story. The live story may be identified to the user by the messaging client application **104**, based on his or her location. The end result is a “live story” told from a community perspective.

(51) A further type of content collection is known as a “location story”, which enables a user whose client device **102** is located within a specific geographic location (e.g., on a college or university campus) to contribute to a particular collection. In some embodiments, a contribution to a location story may require a second degree of authentication to verify that the end user belongs to a specific organization or other entity (e.g., is a student on the university campus).

(52) FIG. **4** is a schematic diagram illustrating a structure of a message **400**, according to some in some embodiments, generated by a messaging client application **104** for communication to a further messaging client application **104** or the messaging server application **114**. The content of a particular message **400** is used to populate the message table **314** stored within the database **120**, accessible by the messaging server application **114**. Similarly, the content of a message **400** is stored in memory as “in-transit” or “in-flight” data of the client device **102** or the application server **112**. The message **400** is shown to include the following components: A message identifier **402**: a unique identifier that identifies the message **400**. A message text payload **404**: text, to be generated by a user via a user interface of the client device **102** and that is included in the message **400**. A message image payload **406**: image data, captured by a camera component of a client device **102** or retrieved from memory of a client device **102**, and that is included in the message **400**. A message video payload **408**: video data, captured by a camera component or retrieved from a memory component of the client device **102** and that is included in the message **400**. A message audio payload **410**: audio data, captured by a microphone or retrieved from the memory component of the client device **102**, and that is included in the message **400**. A message annotations **412**: annotation data (e.g., filters, stickers or other enhancements) that represents annotations to be applied to message image payload **406**, message video payload **408**, or message audio payload **410** of the message **400**. A message duration parameter **414**: parameter value indicating, in seconds, the amount of time for which content of the message (e.g., the message image payload **406**, message video payload **408**, message audio payload **410**) is to be presented or made accessible to a user via the messaging client application **104**. A message geolocation parameter **416**: geolocation data (e.g., latitudinal and longitudinal coordinates) associated with the content payload of the message. Multiple message geolocation parameter **416** values may be included in the payload, each of these parameter values being associated with respect to content items included in the content (e.g., a specific image into within the message image payload **406**, or a specific video in the message video payload **408**). A message story identifier **418**: identifier values identifying one or more content collections (e.g., “stories”) with which a particular content item in the message image payload **406** of the message **400** is associated. For example, multiple images within the message image payload **406** may each be associated with multiple content collections using identifier values. A message tag **420**: each message **400** may be tagged with multiple tags, each of which is indicative of the subject matter of content included in the message payload. For example, where a particular image included in the message image payload **406** depicts an animal (e.g., a lion), a tag value may be included within the message tag **420** that is indicative of the relevant animal. Tag values may be generated manually, based on user input, or may be automatically generated using, for example, image

recognition. A message sender identifier **422**: an identifier (e.g., a messaging system identifier, email address or device identifier) indicative of a user of the client device **102** on which the message **400** was generated and from which the message **400** was sent. A message receiver identifier **424**: an identifier (e.g., a messaging system identifier, email address or device identifier) indicative of a user of the client device **102** to which the message **400** is addressed.

(53) The contents (e.g. values) of the various components of message **400** may be pointers to locations in tables within which content data values are stored. For example, an image value in the message image payload **406** may be a pointer to (or address of) a location within an image table **308**. Similarly, values within the message video payload **408** may point to data stored within a video table **310**, values stored within the message annotations **412** may point to data stored in an annotation table **312**, values stored within the message story identifier **418** may point to data stored in a story table **306**, and values stored within the message sender identifier **422** and the message receiver identifier **424** may point to user records stored within an entity table **302**.

(54) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram illustrating an access-limiting process **500**, in terms of which access to content (e.g., an ephemeral message **502**, and associated multimedia payload of data) or a content collection (e.g., an ephemeral message story **504**) may be time-limited (e.g., made ephemeral).

(55) An ephemeral message **502** is shown to be associated with a message duration parameter **506**, the value of which determines an amount of time that the ephemeral message **502** will be displayed to a receiving user of the ephemeral message **502** by the messaging client application **104**. In one embodiment, where the messaging client application **104** is a SNAPCHAT application client, an ephemeral message **502** is viewable by a receiving user for up to a maximum of 10 seconds, depending on the amount of time that the sending user specifies using the message duration parameter **506**.

(56) The message duration parameter **506** and the message receiver identifier **424** are shown to be inputs to a message timer **512**, which is responsible for determining the amount of time that the ephemeral message **502** is shown to a particular receiving user identified by the message receiver identifier **424**. In particular, the ephemeral message **502** will only be shown to the relevant receiving user for a time period determined by the value of the message duration parameter **506**. The message timer **512** is shown to provide output to a more generalized ephemeral timer system **202**, which is responsible for the overall timing of display of content (e.g., an ephemeral message **502**) to a receiving user.

(57) The ephemeral message **502** is shown in FIG. 5 to be included within an ephemeral message story **504** (e.g., a personal SNAPCHAT story, or an event story). The ephemeral message story **504** has an associated story duration parameter **508**, a value of which determines a time-duration for which the ephemeral message story **504** is presented and accessible to users of the messaging system **100**. The story duration parameter **508**, for example, may be the duration of a music concert, where the ephemeral message story **504** is a collection of content pertaining to that concert. Alternatively, a user (either the owning user or a curator user) may specify the value for the story duration parameter **508** when performing the setup and creation of the ephemeral message story **504**.

(58) Additionally, each ephemeral message **502** within the ephemeral message story **504** has an associated story participation parameter **510**, a value of which determines the duration of time for which the ephemeral message **502** will be accessible within the context of the ephemeral message story **504**. Accordingly, a particular ephemeral message story **504** may “expire” and become inaccessible within the context of the ephemeral message story **504**, prior to the ephemeral message story **504** itself expiring in terms of the story duration parameter **508**. The story duration parameter **508**, story participation parameter **510**, and message receiver identifier **424** each provide input to a story timer **514**, which operationally determines, firstly, whether a particular ephemeral message **502** of the ephemeral message story **504** will be displayed to a particular receiving user and, if so,

for how long. Note that the ephemeral message story **504** is also aware of the identity of the particular receiving user as a result of the message receiver identifier **424**.

(59) Accordingly, the story timer **514** operationally controls the overall lifespan of an associated ephemeral message story **504**, as well as an individual ephemeral message **502** included in the ephemeral message story **504**. In one embodiment, each and every ephemeral message **502** within the ephemeral message story **504** remains viewable and accessible for a time-period specified by the story duration parameter **508**. In a further embodiment, a certain ephemeral message **502** may expire, within the context of ephemeral message story **504**, based on a story participation parameter **510**. Note that a message duration parameter **506** may still determine the duration of time for which a particular ephemeral message **502** is displayed to a receiving user, even within the context of the ephemeral message story **504**. Accordingly, the message duration parameter **506** determines the duration of time that a particular ephemeral message **502** is displayed to a receiving user, regardless of whether the receiving user is viewing that ephemeral message **502** inside or outside the context of an ephemeral message story **504**.

(60) The ephemeral timer system **202** may furthermore operationally remove a particular ephemeral message **502** from the ephemeral message story **504** based on a determination that it has exceeded an associated story participation parameter **510**. For example, when a sending user has established a story participation parameter **510** of 24 hours from posting, the ephemeral timer system **202** will remove the relevant ephemeral message **502** from the ephemeral message story **504** after the specified 24 hours. The ephemeral timer system **202** also operates to remove an ephemeral message story **504** either when the story participation parameter **510** for each and every ephemeral message **502** within the ephemeral message story **504** has expired, or when the ephemeral message story **504** itself has expired in terms of the story duration parameter **508**.

(61) In certain use cases, a creator of a particular ephemeral message story **504** may specify an indefinite story duration parameter **508**. In this case, the expiration of the story participation parameter **510** for the last remaining ephemeral message **502** within the ephemeral message story **504** will determine when the ephemeral message story **504** itself expires. In this case, a new ephemeral message **502**, added to the ephemeral message story **504**, with a new story participation parameter **510**, effectively extends the life of an ephemeral message story **504** to equal the value of the story participation parameter **510**.

(62) Responsive to the ephemeral timer system **202** determining that an ephemeral message story **504** has expired (e.g., is no longer accessible), the ephemeral timer system **202** communicates with the messaging system **100** (and, for example, specifically the messaging client application **104** to cause an indicium (e.g., an icon) associated with the relevant ephemeral message story **504** to no longer be displayed within a user interface of the messaging client application **104**. Similarly, when the ephemeral timer system **202** determines that the message duration parameter **506** for a particular ephemeral message **502** has expired, the ephemeral timer system **202** causes the messaging client application **104** to no longer display an indicium (e.g., an icon or textual identification) associated with the ephemeral message **502**.

(63) FIG. **6** is a block diagram illustrating components of the media preview system **124**, that configure the media preview system **124** to receive media content at a server, generate a preview of the media content, associate a coded image with the preview, receive a scan of the coded image, and cause display of the preview, according to some example embodiments. The media preview system **124** is shown as including a media module **602**, a preview module **604**, a coded image module **606**, and a display module **608**, all configured to communicate with each other (e.g., via a bus, shared memory, or a switch). Any one or more of these modules may be implemented using one or more processors **610** (e.g., by configuring such one or more processors to perform functions described for that module) and hence may include one or more of the processors **610**.

(64) Any one or more of the modules described may be implemented using hardware alone (e.g., one or more of the processors **610** of a machine) or a combination of hardware and software. For

example, any module described of the media preview system **124** may physically include an arrangement of one or more of the processors **610** (e.g., a subset of or among the one or more processors of the machine) configured to perform the operations described herein for that module. As another example, any module of the media preview system **124** may include software, hardware, or both, that configure an arrangement of one or more processors **610** (e.g., among the one or more processors of the machine) to perform the operations described herein for that module. Accordingly, different modules of the media preview system **124** may include and configure different arrangements of such processors **610** or a single arrangement of such processors **610** at different points in time. Moreover, any two or more modules of the media preview system **124** may be combined into a single module, and the functions described herein for a single module may be subdivided among multiple modules. Furthermore, according to various example embodiments, modules described herein as being implemented within a single machine, database, or device may be distributed across multiple machines, databases, or devices.

(65) FIG. 7A includes a depiction of a coded image **702** and a presentation of a preview **704** of media content at a client device **102**, according to certain example embodiments. As seen in FIG. 7, the client device **102** may be used to capture/scan the coded image **702**. The coded image module **606** of the media preview system **124** may detect the scan of the coded image **602** by the client device **102**, and in response, the display module **608** may retrieve a preview associated with the coded image **602** within a database of a server (e.g., the preview **704**). In some example embodiments, the preview **704** may include a watermark.

(66) FIG. 7 also includes a notification **706**. In some example embodiments, the display module **608** may cause display of the notification **706** in response to the coded image module **606** detecting the scan of the coded image **702**. The notification **706** may include a request for the user of the client device **102** to display or dismiss the preview **704**. In some example embodiments, the notification **706** may include an indication of how long the preview is available for viewing. For example, the indication may include a timer (e.g., 24:24:05 remaining, 1 day remaining, etc.), or an indication of how many views of the preview are remaining (e.g., 10 scans left before preview expires).

(67) A user of the client device **102** may select to display the preview **704** through the notification **706**, and in response, the display module **608** may cause display of the preview **704** at the client device **102**. Alternatively, if the user selects to dismiss the preview through the notification **706**, the display module **608** may not cause display of the preview **704**.

(68) FIG. 7B includes a graphical user interface **700** that includes a presentation of a preview library **708** displayed at a client device (e.g., client device **102**), according to certain example embodiments. The preview library **708** is shown to include a set of previews of media items, such as preview **712**. In some example embodiments, the preview module **604** may generate previews of media content (e.g., preview **712**), and cause display of the previews within the preview library **708**.

(69) In some example embodiments, a user may select a preview (e.g., the preview **712**) via a user input (e.g., via a cursor **710**, or through a tactile input into a touch enabled device). In response, the media preview module **124** may retrieve and present to the user a coded image (e.g., coded image **702** of FIG. 7A), such that the user may distribute or share the coded image **702** with a group of reviewers. In further embodiments, the preview library **708** may itself be associated with a coded image (e.g., coded image **702**), such that by scanning the coded image **702**, the user may be presented with the preview library **708**.

(70) In some example embodiments, a user may manage the previews within the preview library **708** via one or more input fields in the preview library **708**. For example, a user may disable a preview via one or more user inputs into the preview library **708**. For example, the user may turn on and off the preview such that users scanning the associated coded image may not be presented with the preview.

(71) FIG. 8 is a flowchart illustrating a method **800** for displaying a preview of media content at a client device, according to certain example embodiments. Operations of the method **800** may be performed by the modules described above with respect to FIG. 6. As shown in FIG. 8, the method **800** includes one or more operations **802**, **804**, **806**, **808**, and **810**.

(72) At operation **802**, the media module **602** receives media content at a server associated with the media preview system **124**. For example, a client device **102** in communication with the media preview system **124** may submit media content that includes collections of text, image video and audio data, as described in FIG. 2. For example, the media content may include collections of content made available as a “story” for the duration of an event, or media overlays and filters.

(73) At operation **804**, the preview module **604** generates a preview of the media content, wherein the preview of the media content includes access parameters. In some example embodiments, to generate the preview of the media content, the preview module **604** alters the media content with a watermark. In further embodiments, the preview module **604** may change or remove geolocation criteria, or temporal criteria associated with the media content in generating the preview. For example, the media content may be configured to include geolocation criteria that requires viewers to be at a specific location in order to gain access to the media content, or similarly may only be viewed at specific time periods. The preview of the media content may remove these criteria in order for a reviewer to view the preview at their own time and place of choosing.

(74) In some example embodiments, the access parameters assigned to the coded image may include access credentials such as user identifier, title, team name, and device identifier. The access parameters may also include a set of termination events, such as a time period in which the preview may be available through the coded image, or a maximum number of scans of the coded image before the preview becomes unavailable.

(75) At operation **806**, the coded image module **606** associated a coded image (e.g., coded image **702** of FIG. 7A) with the preview at a memory location of a database associated with the media preview system **124**. The coded image may for example include a barcode, QR code, or other similar graphical icon, such that referencing the coded image causes the media preview system **124** to retrieve and present the associated preview.

(76) In some example embodiments, the media preview system **124** may present the coded image associated with the preview to an administrator, or user, which created the media content in order for the user to distribute or otherwise share the coded image. For example, the media preview system **124** may cause the coded image to be printed (e.g., on paper, or on stickers or decals), or simply displayed in an email or other message. The user may then distribute the coded image physically or electronically.

(77) At operation **808**, the coded image module **606** detects a scan of the coded image by a client device. For example, a user may scan the coded image via an input component (e.g., a camera) of a client device **102**. Upon scanning the coded image, the client device **102** may transmit a request to the media preview system **124** that includes coded image data from the coded image, as well as user data and client device data associated with the client device.

(78) At operation **810**, the display module **608** causes display of the preview at the client device **102** in response to detecting the scan of the coded image. In some example embodiments, the display module **608** may validate the requesting user based on the access parameters of the coded image and the user data and client device data associated with the client device.

(79) FIG. 9 is a flowchart illustrating a method **900** for denying access to a preview of media content at a client device, according to certain example embodiments. Operations of the method **900** may be performed by the modules described above with respect to FIG. 6. As shown in FIG. 9, the method **900** includes one or more operations **902**, **904**, **906** and **908**. The method **900** may be performed as part (e.g., a precursor task, a subroutine, or a portion) of the method **800**, according to some example embodiments.

(80) At operation **902**, the preview module **604** initiates an access timer associated with the preview

in response to receiving a scan of the coded image (e.g., coded image **702** of FIG. **7A**). The access parameters of the preview may include the access timer. The access timer may define a period of time in which the preview may be accessed via scanning the coded image. For example, the access timer may initiate at the time in which the coded image is first scanned by a device. The access timer may have an associated time limit, such as 24 hours, a week, etc. In some example embodiments, a user may configure the access parameters of the review, including the access timer, by providing a user input that species the time limit at the time in which the media content is provided to the media preview system **124**. For example, a user may indicate that the preview is only to be available by scanning the coded image for a period of 24 hours from the first scan of the coded image.

(81) At operation **904**, the preview module **604** detects an expiration of the access timer. For example, the access timer may initiate in response to detecting a first scan of the coded image associated with the preview. The access timer may run for a period of time defined by a user. The preview module **604** may detect an expiration of the period of time (e.g., 24 hours).

(82) At operation **906**, the coded image module **606** detect a second scan of the coded image prior to the expiration of the access timer. In response to detecting the second scan of the coded image subsequent to the expiration of the access timer, at operation **908**, the preview module **604** denies access to the preview of the media content. For example, the preview module **604** may cause the display module **608** to display an indication that the preview is no longer available for viewing.

(83) FIG. **10** is a flowchart illustrating a method **1000** for denying access to a preview of media content at a client device, according to certain example embodiments. Operations of the method **1000** may be performed by the modules described above with respect to FIG. **6**. As shown in FIG. **10**, the method **1000** includes one or more operations **1002**, **1004**, and **1006**. The method **1000** may be performed as part (e.g., a precursor task, a subroutine, or a portion) of the method **800**, according to some example embodiments.

(84) At operation **1002**, the preview module **604** increments a counter in response to detecting a scan of the coded image by a client device, as described at operation **808** of the method **800** as depicted in FIG. **8**. For example, the access parameters of the preview may include a request limit, wherein the request limit defines a maximum number of times in which the preview may be retrieved by the media preview system **124** in response to detecting a scan of the associated coded image. For example, in response to detecting a scan of the coded image, the preview module **604** may increment a counter, wherein the counter indicates a count of the scans of the coded image. Upon determining that the count of the scans of the coded image exceeds a threshold defined by a request limit, the preview module **604** may deny access to the preview.

(85) At operation **1004**, the preview module **604** determines that the count of the number of scans of the coded image exceeds the request limit. For example, the request limit may indicate that the preview may only be accessed 50 times in response to a scan of the coded image. Upon determining that the count of the number of scans is equal to 50, at operation **1006**, the preview module **604** denies access to the preview of the media content. For example, the display module **606** may cause display of a notification at a client device (e.g., a client device used to scan the coded image), wherein the notification includes an indication that the preview is no longer available.

(86) FIG. **11** is a flowchart illustrating a method **1100** for displaying a preview of media content at a client device, according to certain example embodiments. Operations of the method **1100** may be performed by the modules described above with respect to FIG. **6**. As shown in FIG. **11**, the method **1100** includes one or more operations **1102**, **1104**, and **1106**. The method **1100** may be performed as part (e.g., a precursor task, a subroutine, or a portion) of the method **800**, according to some example embodiments.

(87) At operation **1102**, the media module **602** receives a user input to define a status of media content. For example, as described in FIG. **7B**, a user may manage previews within a preview

library (e.g., preview library **708**) via one or more input fields. For example, the user may disable a preview via a user input into a GUI. For example, the user may change a status of a preview based on one or more selections. The status may indicate that a preview is shareable via a scan of a coded image, or that it is not shareable via a scan of the coded image.

(88) In some example embodiments, a user may specify that the status of the preview is in one or multiple states (e.g., under review, approved, rejected). Each state among the one or more states may have associated access requirements. For example, the access requirements may include credential requirements such as user profile information including user identifier, title, team identifier, etc. In such embodiments, the status of the preview may therefore indicate what users can access the preview. Thus, a preview that is marked with a “review” status, may be available to a predefined population of users, based on specific user profile information, while the same preview marked as “rejected” may only be available to a subset of the population of users, based on their user profile information.

(89) For example, by marking the preview as approved, the preview may be made available to any user which scans the coded image, while marking the preview as rejected may make the preview available to a small population of users, based on the user profile information of the small population of users (e.g., employment status, title, user identifier, etc.).

(90) At operation **1104**, the coded image module **606** retrieves user profile information from a client device (e.g., the client device which scanned the coded image), in response to detecting the scan of the coded image. Based on the user profile information and the status of the preview, at operation **1106** the display module **606** causes display of the preview at the client device.

(91) FIG. **12** is a flowchart illustrating a method **1200** for associating a new coded image with a preview of media content, according to certain example embodiments. Operations of the method **1200** may be performed by the modules described above with respect to FIG. **6**. As shown in FIG. **12**, the method **1200** includes one or more operations **1202**, **1204**, **1206**, **1208**, and **1210**. The method **1200** may be performed as part (e.g., a precursor task, a subroutine, or a portion) of the method **800**, according to some example embodiments.

(92) At operation **1202**, the preview module **604** detects an expiration event based on the access parameters. Expiration events may include detection of an expiration of a timer, or detection of a count of scans of a coded image exceeding a request limit, as described with respect to FIGS. **9** and **10**.

(93) At operation **1204**, the coded image module **606** detects a scan of the coded image, subsequent to the expiration event. For example, the coded image module **606** may detect a scan of the coded image subsequent to the expiration of a timer, or subsequent to the count of the scans of the coded image exceeding the request limit.

(94) At operation **1206**, the preview module **604** denies access to the preview based on the scan of the coded image occurring subsequent to the detection of the expiration event. For example, the preview module **604** may cause the display module **608** to cause display of a notification at the client device, wherein the notification includes an indication that the preview may no longer be accessed.

(95) At operation **1208**, the coded image module **606** generates a new coded image, and associates the preview with the new coded image within a database associated with the media preview system **124**, in response to the denial of the preview request.

(96) At operation **1210**, the coded image module **606** notifies a user (e.g., a user with administrative privileges) that the new coded image has been associated with the preview. The notification may include a presentation of the new coded image, such that the user may distribute or otherwise share the new coded image.

(97) Software Architecture

(98) FIG. **13** is a block diagram illustrating an example software architecture **1306**, which may be used in conjunction with various hardware architectures herein described. FIG. **13** is a non-limiting

example of a software architecture and it will be appreciated that many other architectures may be implemented to facilitate the functionality described herein. The software architecture **1306** may execute on hardware such as machine **1400** of FIG. **14** that includes, among other things, processors **1404**, memory **1414**, and I/O components **1418**. A representative hardware layer **1352** is illustrated and can represent, for example, the machine **1300** of FIG. **13**. The representative hardware layer **1352** includes a processing unit **1354** having associated executable instructions **1304**. Executable instructions **1304** represent the executable instructions of the software architecture **1306**, including implementation of the methods, components and so forth described herein. The hardware layer **1352** also includes memory and/or storage modules memory/storage **1356**, which also have executable instructions **1304**. The hardware layer **1352** may also comprise other hardware **1358**.

(99) In the example architecture of FIG. **13**, the software architecture **1306** may be conceptualized as a stack of layers where each layer provides particular functionality. For example, the software architecture **1306** may include layers such as an operating system **1302**, libraries **1320**, applications **1316** and a presentation layer **1314**. Operationally, the applications **1316** and/or other components within the layers may invoke application programming interface (API) API calls **1308** through the software stack and receive a response as in response to the API calls **1308**. The layers illustrated are representative in nature and not all software architectures have all layers. For example, some mobile or special purpose operating systems may not provide a frameworks/middleware **1318**, while others may provide such a layer. Other software architectures may include additional or different layers.

(100) The operating system **1302** may manage hardware resources and provide common services. The operating system **1302** may include, for example, a kernel **1322**, services **1324** and drivers **1326**. The kernel **1322** may act as an abstraction layer between the hardware and the other software layers. For example, the kernel **1322** may be responsible for memory management, processor management (e.g., scheduling), component management, networking, security settings, and so on. The services **1324** may provide other common services for the other software layers. The drivers **1326** are responsible for controlling or interfacing with the underlying hardware. For instance, the drivers **1326** include display drivers, camera drivers, Bluetooth® drivers, flash memory drivers, serial communication drivers (e.g., Universal Serial Bus (USB) drivers), Wi-Fi® drivers, audio drivers, power management drivers, and so forth depending on the hardware configuration.

(101) The libraries **1320** provide a common infrastructure that is used by the applications **1316** and/or other components and/or layers. The libraries **1320** provide functionality that allows other software components to perform tasks in an easier fashion than to interface directly with the underlying operating system **1302** functionality (e.g., kernel **1322**, services **1324** and/or drivers **1326**). The libraries **1320** may include system libraries **1344** (e.g., C standard library) that may provide functions such as memory allocation functions, string manipulation functions, mathematical functions, and the like. In addition, the libraries **1320** may include API libraries **1346** such as media libraries (e.g., libraries to support presentation and manipulation of various media format such as MPREG4, H.264, MP3, AAC, AMR, JPG, PNG), graphics libraries (e.g., an OpenGL framework that may be used to render 2D and 3D in a graphic content on a display), database libraries (e.g., SQLite that may provide various relational database functions), web libraries (e.g., WebKit that may provide web browsing functionality), and the like. The libraries **1320** may also include a wide variety of other libraries **1348** to provide many other APIs to the applications **1316** and other software components/modules.

(102) The frameworks/middleware **1318** (also sometimes referred to as middleware) provide a higher-level common infrastructure that may be used by the applications **1316** and/or other software components/modules. For example, the frameworks/middleware **1318** may provide various graphic user interface (GUI) functions, high-level resource management, high-level location services, and so forth. The frameworks/middleware **1318** may provide a broad spectrum of

other APIs that may be utilized by the applications **1316** and/or other software components/modules, some of which may be specific to a particular operating system **1302** or platform.

(103) The applications **1316** include built-in applications **1338** and/or third-party applications **1340**. Examples of representative built-in applications **1338** may include, but are not limited to, a contacts application, a browser application, a book reader application, a location application, a media application, a messaging application, and/or a game application. Third-party applications **1340** may include an application developed using the ANDROID™ or IOS™ software development kit (SDK) by an entity other than the vendor of the particular platform, and may be mobile software running on a mobile operating system such as IOS™, ANDROID™, WINDOWS® Phone, or other mobile operating systems. The third-party applications **1340** may invoke the API calls **1308** provided by the mobile operating system (such as operating system **1302**) to facilitate functionality described herein.

(104) The applications **1316** may use built in operating system functions (e.g., kernel **1322**, services **1324** and/or drivers **1326**), libraries **1320**, and frameworks/middleware **1318** to create user interfaces to interact with users of the system. Alternatively, or additionally, in some systems interactions with a user may occur through a presentation layer, such as presentation layer **1314**. In these systems, the application/component “logic” can be separated from the aspects of the application/component that interact with a user.

(105) FIG. **12** is a block diagram illustrating components of a machine **1400**, according to some example embodiments, able to read instructions from a machine-readable medium (e.g., a machine-readable storage medium) and perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein. Specifically, FIG. **14** shows a diagrammatic representation of the machine **1400** in the example form of a computer system, within which instructions **1410** (e.g., software, a program, an application, an applet, an app, or other executable code) for causing the machine **1400** to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein may be executed. As such, the instructions **1410** may be used to implement modules or components described herein. The instructions **1410** transform the general, non-programmed machine **1400** into a particular machine **1400** programmed to carry out the described and illustrated functions in the manner described. In alternative embodiments, the machine **1400** operates as a standalone device or may be coupled (e.g., networked) to other machines. In a networked deployment, the machine **1400** may operate in the capacity of a server machine or a client machine in a server-client network environment, or as a peer machine in a peer-to-peer (or distributed) network environment. The machine **1400** may comprise, but not be limited to, a server computer, a client computer, a personal computer (PC), a tablet computer, a laptop computer, a netbook, a set-top box (STB), a personal digital assistant (PDA), an entertainment media system, a cellular telephone, a smart phone, a mobile device, a wearable device (e.g., a smart watch), a smart home device (e.g., a smart appliance), other smart devices, a web appliance, a network router, a network switch, a network bridge, or any machine capable of executing the instructions **1410**, sequentially or otherwise, that specify actions to be taken by machine **1400**. Further, while only a single machine **1400** is illustrated, the term “machine” shall also be taken to include a collection of machines that individually or jointly execute the instructions **1410** to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein.

(106) The machine **1400** may include processors **1404**, memory memory/storage **1406**, and I/O components **1418**, which may be configured to communicate with each other such as via a bus **1402**. The memory/storage **1406** may include a memory **1414**, such as a main memory, or other memory storage, and a storage unit **1416**, both accessible to the processors **1404** such as via the bus **1402**. The storage unit **1416** and memory **1414** store the instructions **1410** embodying any one or more of the methodologies or functions described herein. The instructions **1410** may also reside, completely or partially, within the memory **1414**, within the storage unit **1416**, within at least one of the processors **1404** (e.g., within the processor's cache memory), or any suitable combination

thereof, during execution thereof by the machine **1400**. Accordingly, the memory **1414**, the storage unit **1416**, and the memory of processors **1404** are examples of machine-readable media.

(107) The I/O components **1418** may include a wide variety of components to receive input, provide output, produce output, transmit information, exchange information, capture measurements, and so on. The specific I/O components **1418** that are included in a particular machine **1400** will depend on the type of machine. For example, portable machines such as mobile phones will likely include a touch input device or other such input mechanisms, while a headless server machine will likely not include such a touch input device. It will be appreciated that the I/O components **1418** may include many other components that are not shown in FIG. **14**. The I/O components **1418** are grouped according to functionality merely for simplifying the following discussion and the grouping is in no way limiting. In various example embodiments, the I/O components **1418** may include output components **1426** and input components **1428**. The output components **1426** may include visual components (e.g., a display such as a plasma display panel (PDP), a light emitting diode (LED) display, a liquid crystal display (LCD), a projector, or a cathode ray tube (CRT)), acoustic components (e.g., speakers), haptic components (e.g., a vibratory motor, resistance mechanisms), other signal generators, and so forth. The input components **1428** may include alphanumeric input components (e.g., a keyboard, a touch screen configured to receive alphanumeric input, a photo-optical keyboard, or other alphanumeric input components), point based input components (e.g., a mouse, a touchpad, a trackball, a joystick, a motion sensor, or other pointing instrument), tactile input components (e.g., a physical button, a touch screen that provides location and/or force of touches or touch gestures, or other tactile input components), audio input components (e.g., a microphone), and the like.

(108) In further example embodiments, the I/O components **1418** may include biometric components **1430**, motion components **1434**, environmental environment components **1436**, or position components **1438** among a wide array of other components. For example, the biometric components **1430** may include components to detect expressions (e.g., hand expressions, facial expressions, vocal expressions, body gestures, or eye tracking), measure biosignals (e.g., blood pressure, heart rate, body temperature, perspiration, or brain waves), identify a person (e.g., voice identification, retinal identification, facial identification, fingerprint identification, or electroencephalogram based identification), and the like. The motion components **1434** may include acceleration sensor components (e.g., accelerometer), gravitation sensor components, rotation sensor components (e.g., gyroscope), and so forth. The environment components **1436** may include, for example, illumination sensor components (e.g., photometer), temperature sensor components (e.g., one or more thermometer that detect ambient temperature), humidity sensor components, pressure sensor components (e.g., barometer), acoustic sensor components (e.g., one or more microphones that detect background noise), proximity sensor components (e.g., infrared sensors that detect nearby objects), gas sensors (e.g., gas detection sensors to detection concentrations of hazardous gases for safety or to measure pollutants in the atmosphere), or other components that may provide indications, measurements, or signals corresponding to a surrounding physical environment. The position components **1438** may include location sensor components (e.g., a Global Position system (GPS) receiver component), altitude sensor components (e.g., altimeters or barometers that detect air pressure from which altitude may be derived), orientation sensor components (e.g., magnetometers), and the like.

(109) Communication may be implemented using a wide variety of technologies. The I/O components **1418** may include communication components **1440** operable to couple the machine **1400** to a network **1432** or devices **1420** via coupling **1422** and coupling **1424** respectively. For example, the communication components **1440** may include a network interface component or other suitable device to interface with the network **1432**. In further examples, communication components **1440** may include wired communication components, wireless communication components, cellular communication components, Near Field Communication (NFC) components,

Bluetooth® components (e.g., Bluetooth® Low Energy), Wi-Fi® components, and other communication components to provide communication via other modalities. The devices **1420** may be another machine or any of a wide variety of peripheral devices (e.g., a peripheral device coupled via a Universal Serial Bus (USB)).

(110) Moreover, the communication components **1440** may detect identifiers or include components operable to detect identifiers. For example, the communication components **1440** may include Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) tag reader components, NFC smart tag detection components, optical reader components (e.g., an optical sensor to detect one-dimensional bar codes such as Universal Product Code (UPC) bar code, multi-dimensional bar codes such as Quick Response (QR) code, Aztec code, Data Matrix, Dataglyph, MaxiCode, PDF417, Ultra Code, UCC RSS-2D bar code, and other optical codes), or acoustic detection components (e.g., microphones to identify tagged audio signals). In addition, a variety of information may be derived via the communication components **1440**, such as, location via Internet Protocol (IP) geo-location, location via Wi-Fi® signal triangulation, location via detecting a NFC beacon signal that may indicate a particular location, and so forth.

Glossary

(111) “CARRIER SIGNAL” in this context refers to any intangible medium that is capable of storing, encoding, or carrying instructions for execution by the machine, and includes digital or analog communications signals or other intangible medium to facilitate communication of such instructions. Instructions may be transmitted or received over the network using a transmission medium via a network interface device and using any one of a number of well-known transfer protocols.

(112) “CLIENT DEVICE” in this context refers to any machine that interfaces to a communications network to obtain resources from one or more server systems or other client devices. A client device may be, but is not limited to, a mobile phone, desktop computer, laptop, portable digital assistants (PDAs), smart phones, tablets, ultra books, netbooks, laptops, multi-processor systems, microprocessor-based or programmable consumer electronics, game consoles, set-top boxes, or any other communication device that a user may use to access a network.

(113) “COMMUNICATIONS NETWORK” in this context refers to one or more portions of a network that may be an ad hoc network, an intranet, an extranet, a virtual private network (VPN), a local area network (LAN), a wireless LAN (WLAN), a wide area network (WAN), a wireless WAN (WWAN), a metropolitan area network (MAN), the Internet, a portion of the Internet, a portion of the Public Switched Telephone Network (PSTN), a plain old telephone service (POTS) network, a cellular telephone network, a wireless network, a Wi-Fi® network, another type of network, or a combination of two or more such networks. For example, a network or a portion of a network may include a wireless or cellular network and the coupling may be a Code Division Multiple Access (CDMA) connection, a Global System for Mobile communications (GSM) connection, or other type of cellular or wireless coupling. In this example, the coupling may implement any of a variety of types of data transfer technology, such as Single Carrier Radio Transmission Technology (1×RTT), Evolution-Data Optimized (EVDO) technology, General Packet Radio Service (GPRS) technology, Enhanced Data rates for GSM Evolution (EDGE) technology, third Generation Partnership Project (3GPP) including 3G, fourth generation wireless (4G) networks, Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (UMTS), High Speed Packet Access (HSPA), Worldwide Interoperability for Microwave Access (WiMAX), Long Term Evolution (LTE) standard, others defined by various standard setting organizations, other long range protocols, or other data transfer technology.

(114) “EMPIERAL MESSAGE” in this context refers to a message that is accessible for a time-limited duration. An ephemeral message may be a text, an image, a video and the like. The access time for the ephemeral message may be set by the message sender. Alternatively, the access time may be a default setting or a setting specified by the recipient. Regardless of the setting

technique, the message is transitory.

(115) “MACHINE-READABLE MEDIUM” in this context refers to a component, device or other tangible media able to store instructions and data temporarily or permanently and may include, but is not be limited to, random-access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), buffer memory, flash memory, optical media, magnetic media, cache memory, other types of storage (e.g., Erasable Programmable Read-Only Memory (EEPROM)) and/or any suitable combination thereof. The term “machine-readable medium” should be taken to include a single medium or multiple media (e.g., a centralized or distributed database, or associated caches and servers) able to store instructions. The term “machine-readable medium” shall also be taken to include any medium, or combination of multiple media, that is capable of storing instructions (e.g., code) for execution by a machine, such that the instructions, when executed by one or more processors of the machine, cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies described herein. Accordingly, a “machine-readable medium” refers to a single storage apparatus or device, as well as “cloud-based” storage systems or storage networks that include multiple storage apparatus or devices. The term “machine-readable medium” excludes signals per se.

(116) “COMPONENT” in this context refers to a device, physical entity or logic having boundaries defined by function or subroutine calls, branch points, application program interfaces (APIs), or other technologies that provide for the partitioning or modularization of particular processing or control functions. Components may be combined via their interfaces with other components to carry out a machine process. A component may be a packaged functional hardware unit designed for use with other components and a part of a program that usually performs a particular function of related functions. Components may constitute either software components (e.g., code embodied on a machine-readable medium) or hardware components. A “hardware component” is a tangible unit capable of performing certain operations and may be configured or arranged in a certain physical manner. In various example embodiments, one or more computer systems (e.g., a standalone computer system, a client computer system, or a server computer system) or one or more hardware components of a computer system (e.g., a processor or a group of processors) may be configured by software (e.g., an application or application portion) as a hardware component that operates to perform certain operations as described herein. A hardware component may also be implemented mechanically, electronically, or any suitable combination thereof. For example, a hardware component may include dedicated circuitry or logic that is permanently configured to perform certain operations. A hardware component may be a special-purpose processor, such as a Field-Programmable Gate Array (FPGA) or an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC). A hardware component may also include programmable logic or circuitry that is temporarily configured by software to perform certain operations. For example, a hardware component may include software executed by a general-purpose processor or other programmable processor. Once configured by such software, hardware components become specific machines (or specific components of a machine) uniquely tailored to perform the configured functions and are no longer general-purpose processors. It will be appreciated that the decision to implement a hardware component mechanically, in dedicated and permanently configured circuitry, or in temporarily configured circuitry (e.g., configured by software) may be driven by cost and time considerations. Accordingly, the phrase “hardware component” (or “hardware-implemented component”) should be understood to encompass a tangible entity, be that an entity that is physically constructed, permanently configured (e.g., hardwired), or temporarily configured (e.g., programmed) to operate in a certain manner or to perform certain operations described herein. Considering embodiments in which hardware components are temporarily configured (e.g., programmed), each of the hardware components need not be configured or instantiated at any one instance in time. For example, where a hardware component comprises a general-purpose processor configured by software to become a special-purpose processor, the general-purpose processor may be configured as respectively different special-purpose processors (e.g., comprising different hardware components) at different

times. Software accordingly configures a particular processor or processors, for example, to constitute a particular hardware component at one instance of time and to constitute a different hardware component at a different instance of time. Hardware components can provide information to, and receive information from, other hardware components. Accordingly, the described hardware components may be regarded as being communicatively coupled. Where multiple hardware components exist contemporaneously, communications may be achieved through signal transmission (e.g., over appropriate circuits and buses) between or among two or more of the hardware components. In embodiments in which multiple hardware components are configured or instantiated at different times, communications between such hardware components may be achieved, for example, through the storage and retrieval of information in memory structures to which the multiple hardware components have access. For example, one hardware component may perform an operation and store the output of that operation in a memory device to which it is communicatively coupled. A further hardware component may then, at a later time, access the memory device to retrieve and process the stored output. Hardware components may also initiate communications with input or output devices, and can operate on a resource (e.g., a collection of information). The various operations of example methods described herein may be performed, at least partially, by one or more processors that are temporarily configured (e.g., by software) or permanently configured to perform the relevant operations. Whether temporarily or permanently configured, such processors may constitute processor-implemented components that operate to perform one or more operations or functions described herein. As used herein, “processor-implemented component” refers to a hardware component implemented using one or more processors. Similarly, the methods described herein may be at least partially processor-implemented, with a particular processor or processors being an example of hardware. For example, at least some of the operations of a method may be performed by one or more processors or processor-implemented components. Moreover, the one or more processors may also operate to support performance of the relevant operations in a “cloud computing” environment or as a “software as a service” (SaaS). For example, at least some of the operations may be performed by a group of computers (as examples of machines including processors), with these operations being accessible via a network (e.g., the Internet) and via one or more appropriate interfaces (e.g., an Application Program Interface (API)). The performance of certain of the operations may be distributed among the processors, not only residing within a single machine, but deployed across a number of machines. In some example embodiments, the processors or processor-implemented components may be located in a single geographic location (e.g., within a home environment, an office environment, or a server farm). In other example embodiments, the processors or processor-implemented components may be distributed across a number of geographic locations.

(117) “PROCESSOR” in this context refers to any circuit or virtual circuit (a physical circuit emulated by logic executing on an actual processor) that manipulates data values according to control signals (e.g., “commands”, “op codes”, “machine code”, etc.) and which produces corresponding output signals that are applied to operate a machine. A processor may, for example, be a Central Processing Unit (CPU), a Reduced Instruction Set Computing (RISC) processor, a Complex Instruction Set Computing (CISC) processor, a Graphics Processing Unit (GPU), a Digital Signal Processor (DSP), an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC), a Radio-Frequency Integrated Circuit (RFIC) or any combination thereof. A processor may further be a multi-core processor having two or more independent processors (sometimes referred to as “cores”) that may execute instructions contemporaneously.

(118) “TIMESTAMP” in this context refers to a sequence of characters or encoded information identifying when a certain event occurred, for example giving date and time of day, sometimes accurate to a small fraction of a second.

(119) “LIFT” in this context is a measure of the performance of a targeted model at predicting or

classifying cases as having an enhanced response (with respect to a population as a whole), measured against a random choice targeting model.

Claims

1. A media preview system comprising: a memory; and at least one hardware processor coupled to the memory and comprising instructions that causes the media preview system to perform operations comprising: receiving, by a remote server, media content from a first client device associated with an entity; generating, by the remote server, a preview of the media content, the preview of the media content comprising a set of access parameters that includes a threshold of a request limit and geolocation criteria; generating, by the remote server, a coded image that comprises a QR code that integrates a display of an entity logo associated with the entity as a machine-readable finder pattern within the QR code; associating, by the remote server, the coded image with the preview of the media content at a database; causing display of the coded image on a shareable means by the remote server, the shareable means being accessible by a second client device; generating, by the remote server, a most recent preview of the media content based on changes to the media content and the preview of the media content received, from the first client device; associating, by the remote server, the coded image with the most recent preview of the media content at the database; receiving, from the second client device, a request to access the most recent preview of the media content and a geolocation of the second client device, the request and the geolocation being generated responsive to a scan of the coded image displayed on the shareable means by the second client device; incrementing, by the remote server, a counter associated with the most recent preview of the media content responsive to the request that includes the scan of the coded image, the counter indicating a number of requests to access the most recent preview received from one or more client devices; determining, by the remote server, that the number of requests to access the most recent preview is below the threshold of the request limit and the geolocation of the second client device meets the geolocation criteria; transmitting, by the remote server, data of a notification to the second client device responsive to the receiving the request that comprises the scan of the coded image and the determining that the number of requests to access the most recent preview is below the threshold of the request limit and the geolocation of the second client device meets the geolocation criteria, the data of the notification causing display of the notification on a graphical user interface of the second client device, the notification including a request for a user of the second client device to display or dismiss the most recent preview of the media content; receiving, from the second client device, a request to display the most recent preview of the media content, the request being generated responsive to an input of the user on the second client device that selects to display the most recent preview of the media content; and transmitting, by the remote server, data comprising the most recent preview of the media content to the second client device responsive to the input that selects to display the most recent preview of the media content in the notification, the data related to the most recent preview of the media content causing display of a presentation of the most recent preview at the graphical user interface of the second client device.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the generating the preview of the media content includes applying a digital watermark to the media content.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein the preview corresponds with one or more access parameters, the scan of the coded image is a first scan, and further comprising: detecting an expiration of the preview based on the one or more access parameters; receiving a second scan of the coded image after the expiration of the preview; and denying access to the preview of the media content.
4. The system of claim 3, wherein the one or more access parameters define display criteria of the preview based on user profile information, and further comprising: assigning a status indicator to the media content, the status indicator indicating a state of the media content; retrieving user profile

information from the second client device in response to the receiving the request; and causing display of the preview at the second client device based on the user profile information and the state of the media content.

5. The system of claim 3, wherein the scan of the coded image is a first scan, and further comprising: detecting an expiration event based on the access parameters; receiving a second scan of the coded image subsequent to the expiration event; denying access to the preview based on the second scan being subsequent to the expiration event; associating a new coded image with the preview in response to the denying access to the preview; and notifying an administrator associated with the media content of the new coded image.

6. The system of claim 3, wherein the access parameters include a request limit, and further comprising: incrementing a counter responsive to the request; determining that a count indicated by the counter exceeds is below the request limit; and causing display of the notification at the second client device based on the count indicated by the counter being below the request limit.

7. The system of claim 1, wherein the media content is a first media content, the preview is a first preview, and further comprising: receiving second media content at the system; generating a second preview of the second media content; associating the coded image with the second preview of the second media content; receiving the scan of the coded image from the second client device; and causing display of a preview library at the second client device in response to the receiving the scan, the preview library including presentations of the first preview and the second preview.

8. A method performed by a system comprising a first client device, a second client device, and a remote server for controlling sharing of preview of media content, the method comprising: receiving, by the remote server, media content from the first client device associated with an entity; generating, by the remote server, a preview of the media content, the preview of the media content comprising a set of access parameters that includes a threshold of a request limit and geolocation criteria; generating, by the remote server, a coded image that comprises a QR code that integrates a display of an entity logo associated with the entity as a machine-readable finder pattern within the QR code; associating, by the remote server, the coded image with the preview of the media content at a database; causing display of the coded image on a shareable means by the remote server, the shareable means being accessible by the second client device; generating, by the remote server, a most recent preview of the media content based on changes to the media content and the preview of the media content received, from the first client device; associating, by the remote server, the coded image with the most recent preview of the media content at the database; receiving, from the second client device, a request to access the most recent preview of the media content and a geolocation of the second client device, the request and the geolocation being generated responsive to a scan of the coded image displayed on the shareable means by the second client device; incrementing, by the remote server, a counter associated with the most recent preview of the media content responsive to the request that includes the scan of the coded image, the counter indicating a number of requests to access the most recent preview received from one or more client devices; determining, by the remote server, that the number of requests to access the most recent preview is below the threshold of the request limit and the geolocation of the second client device meets the geolocation criteria; transmitting, by the remote server, data of a notification to the second client device responsive to the receiving the request that comprises the scan of the coded image and the determining that the number of requests to access the most recent preview is below the threshold of the request limit and the geolocation of the second client device meets the geolocation criteria, the data of the notification causing display of the notification on a graphical user interface of the second client device, the notification including a request for a user of the second client device to display or dismiss the most recent preview of the media content; receiving, from the second client device, a request to display the most recent preview of the media content, the request being generated responsive to an input of the user on the second client device that selects to display the most recent preview of the media content; and transmitting, by the remote server, data comprising

the most recent adjusted preview of the media content to the second client device responsive to the input that selects to display the most recent preview of the media content in the notification, the data related to the most recent preview of the media content causing display of a presentation of the most recent preview at the graphical user interface of the second client device.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein the generating the preview of the media content includes applying a digital watermark to the media content.

10. The method of claim 8, wherein the preview corresponds with one or more access parameters, the scan of the coded image is a first scan, and further comprising: detecting an expiration of the preview based on the one or more access parameters; receiving a second scan of the coded image after the expiration of the preview; and denying access to the preview of the media content.

11. The method of claim 10, wherein the one or more access parameters define display criteria of the preview based on user profile information, and further comprising: assigning a status indicator to the media content, the status indicator indicating a state of the media content; retrieving user profile information from the second client device in response to the receiving the request; and causing display of the preview at the second client device based on the user profile information and the state of the media content.

12. The method of claim 10, wherein the scan of the coded image is a first scan, and further comprising: detecting an expiration event based on the access parameters; receiving a second scan of the coded image subsequent to the expiration event; denying access to the preview based on the second scan being subsequent to the expiration event; associating a new coded image with the preview in response to the denying access to the preview; and notifying an administrator associated with the media content of the new coded image.

13. The method of claim 10, wherein the access parameters include a request limit, and further comprising: incrementing a counter responsive to the request; determining that a count indicated by the counter exceeds is below the request limit; and causing display of the notification at the client device based on the count indicated by the counter being below the request limit.

14. The method of claim 8, wherein the media content is a first media content, the preview is a first preview, and further comprising: receiving second media content at the system; generating a second preview of the second media content; associating the coded image with the second preview of the second media content; receiving the scan of the coded image from the client device; and causing display of a preview library at the client device in response to the receiving the scan, the preview library including presentations of the first preview and the second preview.

15. A non-transitory machine-readable storage medium comprising instructions for controlling a sharing of preview of media content from a first client device to a second client device via a remote server of a media preview system that, when executed by one or more processors of a machine, cause the machine to perform operations comprising: receiving, by the remote server, media content from the first client device associated with an entity; generating, by the remote server, a preview of the media content, the preview of the media content comprising a set of access parameters that includes a threshold of a request limit and geolocation criteria; generating, by the remote server, a coded image that comprises a QR code that integrates a display of an entity logo associated with the entity as a machine-readable finder pattern within the QR code; associating, by the remote server, the coded image with the preview of the media content at a database; causing display of the coded image on a shareable means by the remote server, the shareable means being accessible by the second client device; generating, by the remote server, a most recent preview of the media content based on changes to the media content and the preview of the media content received, from the first client device; associating, by the remote server, the coded image with the most recent preview of the media content at the database; receiving, from the second client device, a request to access the most recent preview of the media content and a geolocation of the second client device, the request and the geolocation being generated responsive to a scan of the coded image displayed on the shareable means by the second client device; incrementing, by the remote

server, a counter associated with the most recent preview of the media content responsive to the request that includes the scan of the coded image, the counter indicating a number of requests to access the most recent preview received from one or more client devices; determining, by the remote server, that the number of requests to access the most recent preview is below the threshold of the request limit and the geolocation of the second client device meets the geolocation criteria; transmitting, by the remote server, data of a notification to the second client device responsive to the receiving the request that comprises the scan of the coded image and the determining that the number of requests to access the most recent preview is below the threshold of the request limit and the geolocation of the second client device meets the geolocation criteria, the data of the notification causing display of the notification on a graphical user interface of the second client device, the notification including a request for a user of the second client device to display or dismiss the most recent preview of the media content; receiving, from the second client device, a request to display the most recent preview of the media content, the request being generated responsive to an input of the user on the second client device that selects to display the most recent preview of the media content; and transmitting, by the remote server, data comprising the most recent preview of the media content to the second client device responsive to the input that selects to display the most recent preview of the media content in the notification, the data related to the most recent preview of the media content causing display of a presentation of the most recent preview at the graphical user interface of the second client device.

16. The non-transitory machine-readable storage medium of claim 15, wherein the generating the preview of the media content includes applying a digital watermark to the media content.

17. The non-transitory machine-readable storage medium of claim 15, wherein the preview corresponds with one or more access parameters, the scan of the coded image is a first scan, and further comprising: detecting an expiration of the preview based on the one or more access parameters; receiving a second scan of the coded image after the expiration of the preview; and denying access to the preview of the media content.

18. The non-transitory machine-readable storage medium of claim 17, wherein the one or more access parameters define display criteria of the preview based on user profile information, and further comprising: assigning a status indicator to the media content, the status indicator indicating a state of the media content; retrieving user profile information from the client device in response to the receiving the request; and causing display of the preview at the client device based on the user profile information and the state of the media content.

19. The non-transitory machine-readable storage medium of claim 17, wherein the scan of the coded image is a first scan, and further comprising: detecting an expiration event based on the access parameters; receiving a second scan of the coded image subsequent to the expiration event; denying access to the preview based on the second scan being subsequent to the expiration event; associating a new coded image with the preview in response to the denying access to the preview; and notifying an administrator associated with the media content of the new coded image.

20. The non-transitory machine-readable storage medium of claim 17, wherein the access parameters include a request limit, and further comprising: incrementing a counter responsive to the request; determining that a count indicated by the counter exceeds is below the request limit; and causing display of the notification at the client device based on the count indicated by the counter being below the request limit.
